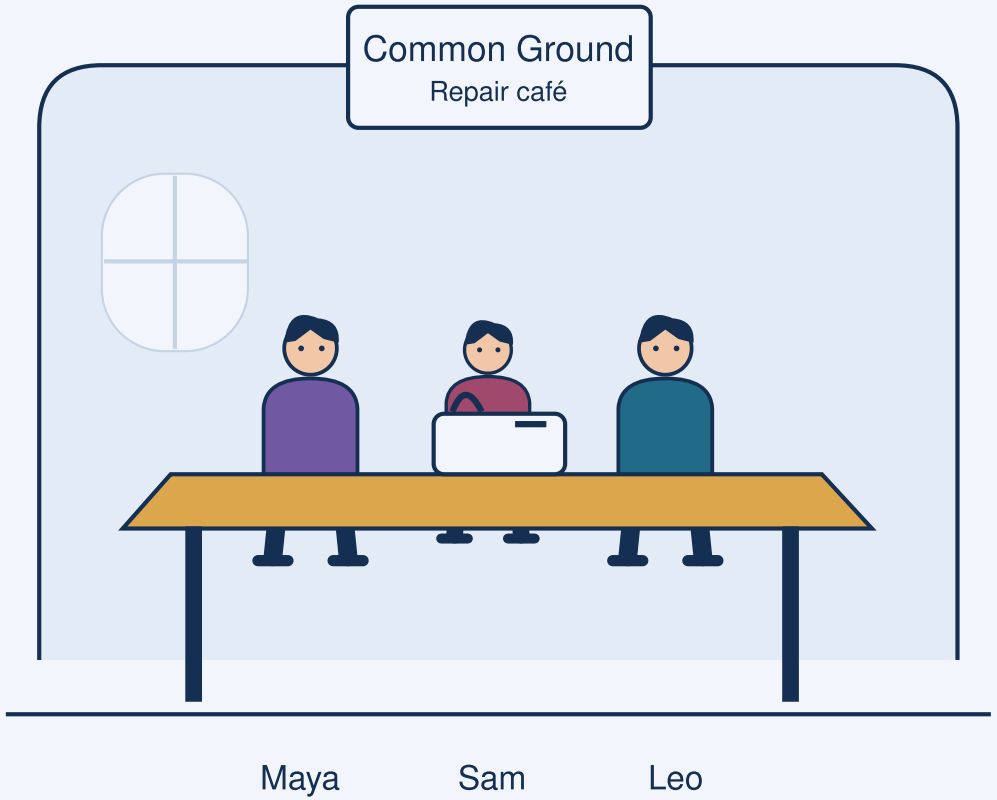
Maya arrives late. The room has already decided why.

An original story at the Common Ground repair café.



What would you do?

Leo is assigning the opening shift. What is his most informative next move?

A Ask Maya about today and check her availability.

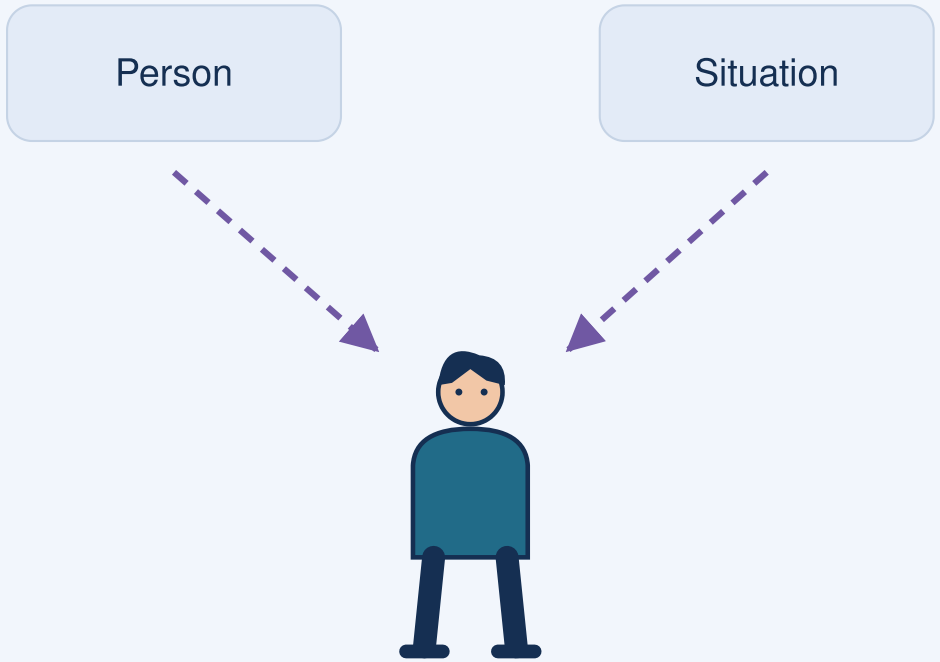
B Use today’s lateness as the main sign of reliability.

C Ignore today and assume she will arrive on time.

Suggested answer: A. He can investigate the obstacle and plan the shift without pretending the lateness did not matter.

Behavior has more than one author.

- Person: habits, values, skills
- Situation: constraints, roles, incentives
- Interaction: a setting affects people differently

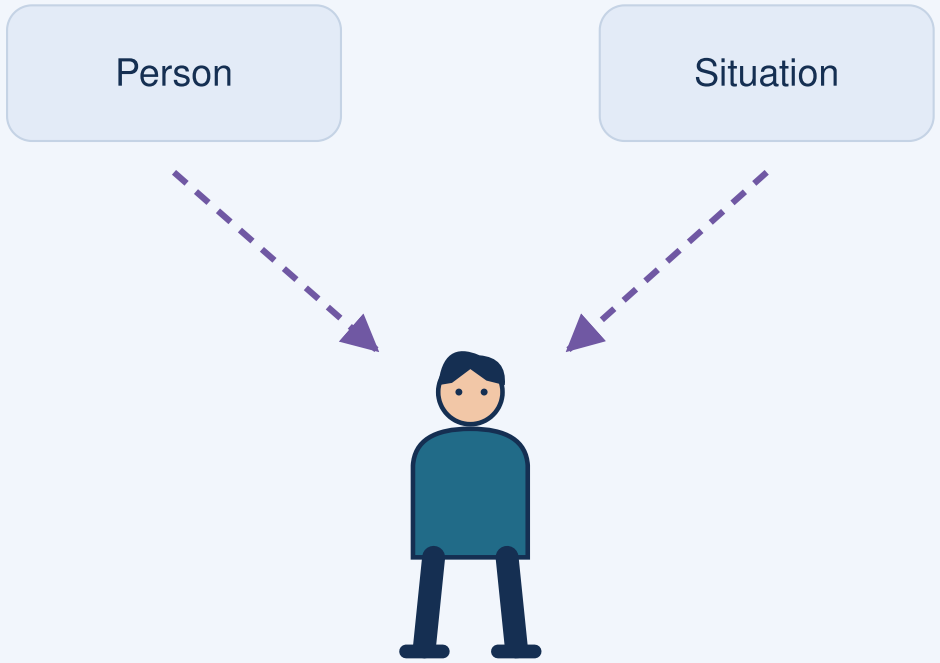


Behavior emerges in context.

Person and situation both contribute to behavior.

Observation is not explanation.

- Observed: Maya arrived after the start.
- Inferred: Maya does not care.
- Test: ask what changes across situations.

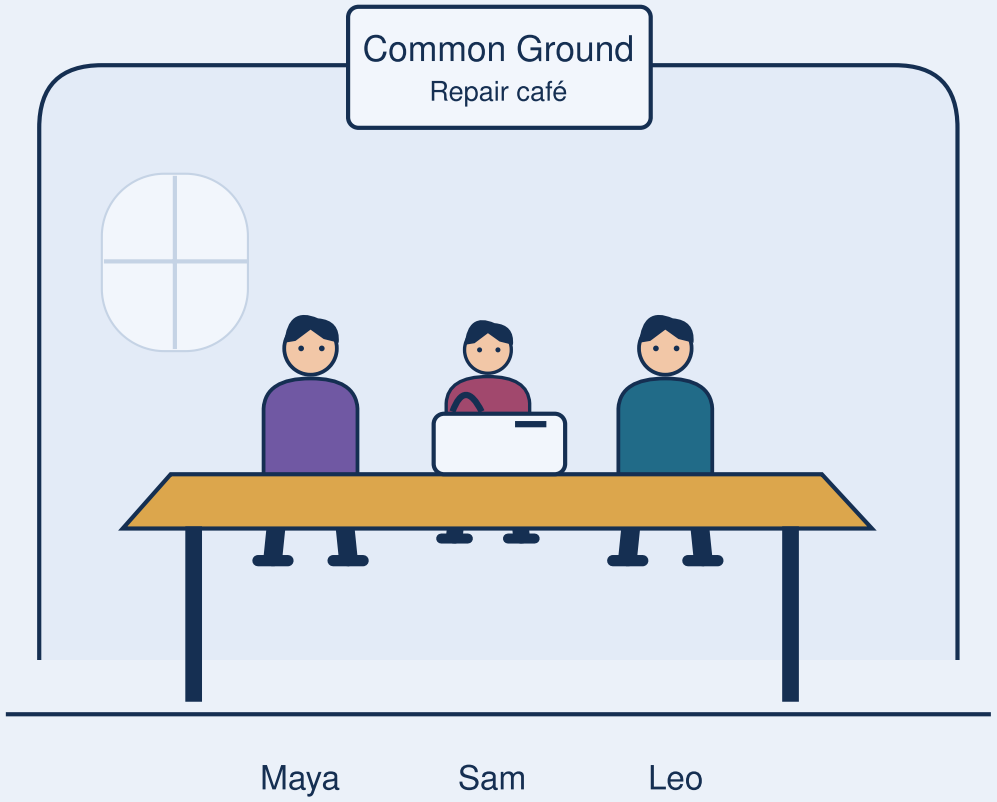


Behavior emerges in context.

Person and situation both contribute to behavior.

What can we really conclude?

Attribution studies describe patterns in judgment, not a law that character never matters. Repeated behavior across varied settings is more informative than one episode. Named effects such as actor–observer differences depend on the judgment and design. Do not turn every bias label into a universal rule or a diagnosis of someone else’s mind.



Conceptual illustration; no research data are plotted.

Try the idea somewhere new.

A volunteer misses shifts only when the bus service is suspended. What should you test?

A Whether personality alone predicts attendance.

B Whether another travel plan improves attendance.

C Whether the missed shifts can be deleted.

Suggested answer: B. Changing the suspected barrier gives useful evidence while keeping expectations clear.

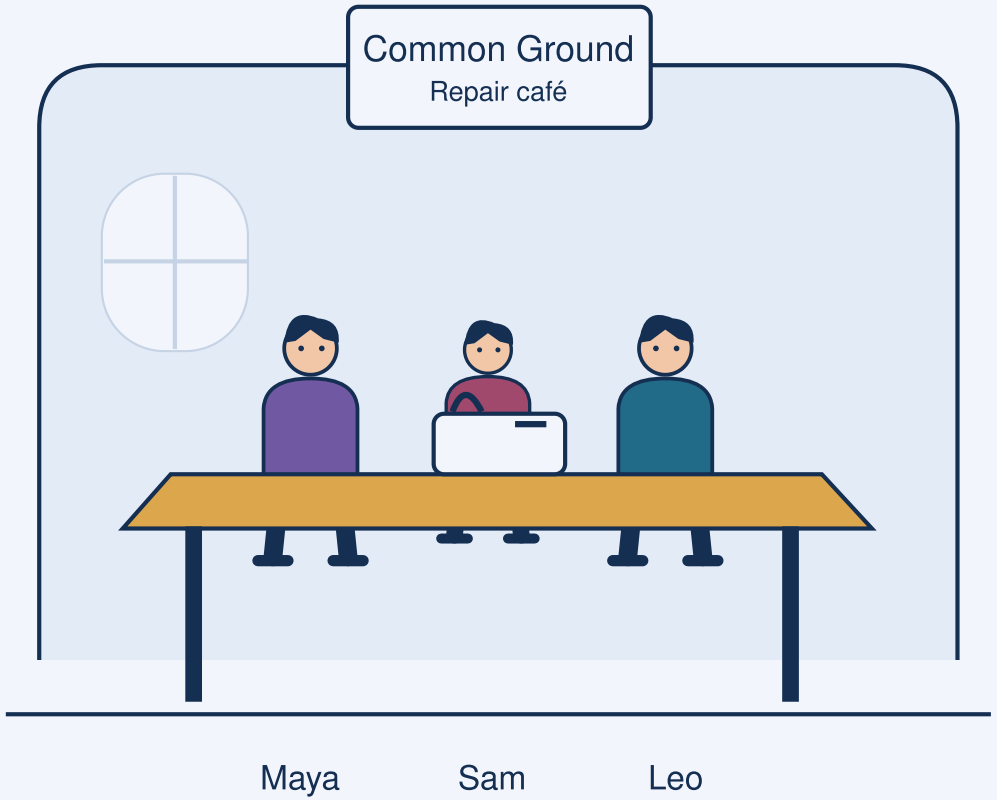
Close your notes. Explain it.

> Explain observation versus attribution.

> What would strengthen a personal explanation?

1. An observation records an action; an attribution proposes its cause.

2. A recurring pattern across varied circumstances, after examining plausible alternatives.

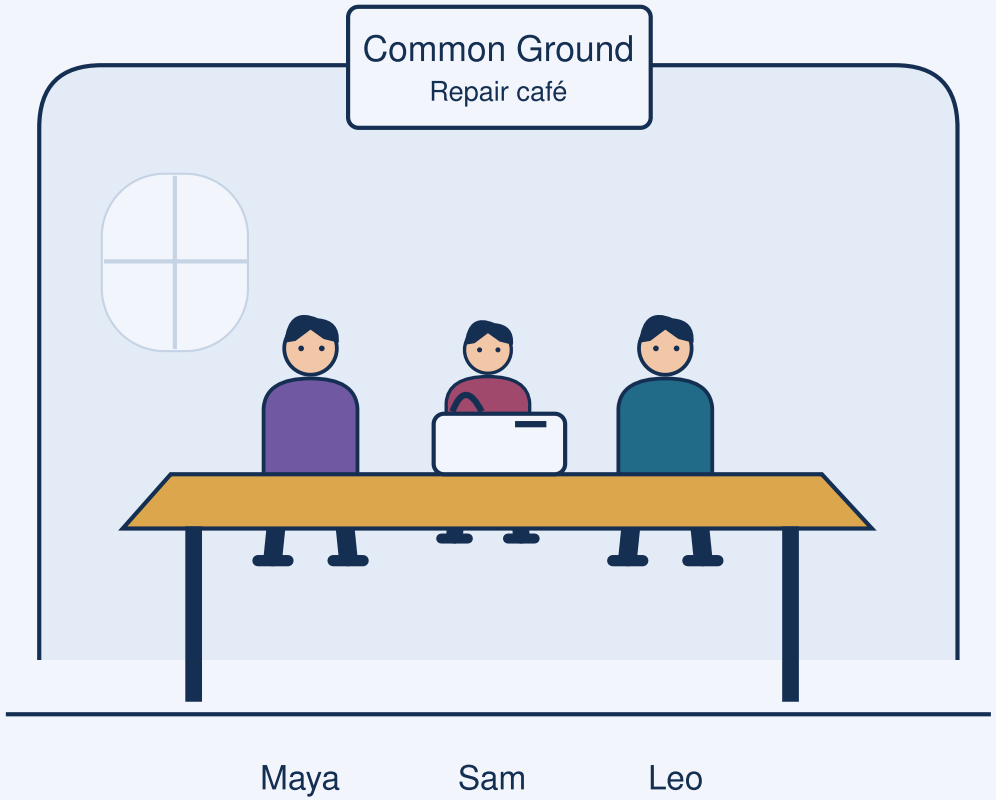


Maya, Sam and Leo at the repair café.

Carry one idea into your week.

Choose a mildly frustrating encounter. Write the action, your first interpretation, two alternatives, and one respectful question that could clarify it.

Revisit tomorrow and in a week.
Explain it without notes, then use a different example.



Take the question into a different setting.